KEY TAKEAWAYS

- The reality is that although India is growing, the quarter on quarter growth is declining—13.5% in Q1, 6.3% in Q2, and 4.4% in Q3
- The good performance of the top 500 companies and the increase in FDI make sense only to the top 700 million Indians and not to the bottom 700 million
- If child stunting and wasting is between 20% and 30%, if 49% of all women are anaemic, then it means that people do not have enough food
- Three out of four rural homes are without piped drinking water. Over 21% of them do not have access to toilet; 33% of teaching posts are vacant in central varsities
- In this global financial turbulence, if India is seen as a stable economy, it will continue to attract foreign investors and companies that can bring skills and technology
- At the end of the lockdown, the rich had a lot of savings, the poor were badly affected. As the economy opened up and the rich started spending, the money started to flow



markets, and that India should aim for macroeconomic stability. This would attract more foreign investors who can bring in skills and technology. Chidambaram said the Modi government was wrong in not giving a fiscal stimulus, because it is disregarding the "bottom half" of the population. Mishra countered by saying that the economy has a natural process of healing, which should not be interrupted by giving sops. Moreover, countries like the US, which had gone overboard with stimulus measures, are now paying the price for their exuberance. ■

NEELKANTH MISHRA
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NREGA demand is lower than February 2020... Rural wage growth was stuck in a rut, but is now 6.5 per cent. For the first time, it is positive in real terms, and is higher than inflation

By 2053, our average age will be about 40. We do not want to grow old before we grow rich. We need to aspire for 8 per cent growth, and for that, we need a lot of foreign capital, skills and technology. We need to ease the issues foreign companies face when they come to India